

Hamish Norwood

Character Dossier

Superstitious and observant acrobat of Verdance, a floating garden city

Overview

Hamish Norwood is a acrobat living in Verdance, a floating garden city. Hamish is 76 years old, originally from Bittermoor, and is known around the Canopy Walk as superstitious and observant. In conversation Hamish quotes half-remembered proverbs, often wrongly.

Background

Hamish arrived in Verdance, a floating garden city 26 years ago after leaving Bittermoor under circumstances Hamish describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Verdance Stewardship; the second was the one that stuck. Today Hamish works as a acrobat near the root-cellar markets and is paid, when paid at all, in seed-notes.

Hamish learned the trade from Mara Irongate, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Hamish's life is with Seraphine Norwood, over a matter neither will explain. The person Hamish trusts most is Umberto Achterberg.

Current goal: to map every path through the Canopy Walk. Greatest fear: mirrors in the dark.

Personality and speech

Temperament: superstitious and observant.

Speech pattern: Hamish quotes half-remembered proverbs, often wrongly.

Tells: when lying, Hamish mentions Fidget the crow for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Hamish Norwood
<i>Role</i>	acrobat
<i>Home</i>	Verdance, a floating garden city
<i>Hometown</i>	Bittermoor
<i>Age</i>	76
<i>Favourite dish</i>	charred goat cheese tart
<i>Pet</i>	Fidget, a crow
<i>Lucky number</i>	425

<i>Workshop password</i>	ember-lattice
<i>Mentor</i>	Mara Irongate
<i>Rival</i>	Seraphine Norwood
<i>Closest friend</i>	Umberto Achterberg

Secret

Hamish is terrified of deep water and hides it with jokes.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Hamish: I am the acrobat. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Hamish: Charred goat cheese tart. Do not tell Seraphine I said so.

Visitor: Is Fidget yours?

Hamish: Fidget belongs to nobody. Fidget tolerates me. Lucky number is 425, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, autumn of year 13

A stranger asked Hamish for the password to the workshop. Hamish laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached Terrace Twelve. Hamish pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Hamish and a neighbour outside Terrace Twelve; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about the census. Hamish read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 2, winter of year 13

The weather turned. Hamish moved the sack of salt indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the singing at the docks. Rumours about the price of lamp oil reached Terrace Twelve. Hamish pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Hamish won 2 seed-notes on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 3, summer of year 13

Hamish closed early, walked to Terrace Twelve, and watched the lights come on. Isadora came by asking about the quarantine. Hamish said nothing useful and made tea instead. Rumours about the old tunnels reached the Canopy Walk. Hamish pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 4, autumn of year 13

Hamish closed early, walked to Terrace Twelve, and watched the lights come on. The weather turned. Hamish moved the ledger indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about who really won the regatta. Hamish was hired to carry a clockwork bird from the Canopy Walk to Terrace Twelve without opening it, and mostly succeeded. the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Hamish read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 5, spring of year 13

Hamish won 69 seed-notes on a bet about the census and spent all of it on supper. Hamish repaired the hand bell at the Canopy Walk for Astrid, who paid in 51 seed-notes and a long story about the comet. Someone left a grain scale on the doorstep with no note. Hamish has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 6, spring of year 13

Winifred came by asking about the singing at the docks. Hamish said nothing useful and made tea instead. The weather turned. Hamish moved the bolt of linen indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the singing at the docks. Rumours about the comet reached the Canopy Walk. Hamish pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the new curfew reached the Canopy Walk. Hamish pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Gideon came by asking about the harvest count. Hamish said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 7, autumn of year 13

Hamish found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the root-cellar markets and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Hamish found a cracked compass half-buried near the root-cellar markets and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Hamish for the password to the workshop. Hamish laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. At the root-cellar markets, Hamish taught a newcomer how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 8, winter of year 13

Hamish was hired to carry a bundle of letters from the tether docks to Terrace Twelve without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Hamish won 5 seed-notes on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on supper. Hamish won 11 seed-notes on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on supper. A stranger asked Hamish for the password to the workshop. Hamish laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Hamish has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 9, autumn of year 13

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before. the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about the old tunnels. Hamish read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Hamish won 7 seed-notes on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 10, spring of year 13

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about the quarantine. Hamish read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Hamish spent the day counting stock at the root-cellar markets: 58 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short.

Entry 11, autumn of year 13

The weather turned. Hamish moved the cracked compass indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tax on doors. A stranger asked Hamish for the password to the workshop. Hamish laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. At Terrace Twelve, Hamish taught a newcomer how to tell a real spool of wire from a fake one by weight alone. Hamish was hired to carry a oilskin map from Terrace Twelve to the root-cellar markets without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 12, winter of year 13

The weather turned. Hamish moved the bundle of letters indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the old tunnels. Hamish closed early, walked to the root-cellar markets, and watched the lights come on. A dispute over the tariff on salt flared up between Hamish and a neighbour outside the Canopy Walk; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Hamish was hired to carry a iron kettle from the Canopy Walk to the root-cellar markets without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Hamish won 83 seed-notes on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 13, summer of year 13

the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about the harvest count. Hamish read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Hamish was hired to carry a pair of spectacles from the tether docks to Terrace Twelve without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Hamish closed early, walked to Terrace Twelve, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 14, autumn of year 13

Hamish won 14 seed-notes on a bet about the old tunnels and spent all of it on supper. Hamish was hired to carry a glass float from the root-cellar markets to the tether docks without opening it, and mostly succeeded. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before. Hamish was hired to carry a bolt of linen from the root-cellar markets to the tether docks without opening it, and mostly succeeded. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 15, summer of year 13

The weather turned. Hamish moved the sack of salt indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew. Hamish closed early, walked to the Canopy Walk, and watched the lights come on. Someone left a iron kettle on the doorstep with no note. Hamish has a suspect and is probably right. Hamish won 84 seed-notes on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on supper. At the root-cellar markets, Hamish taught a newcomer how to tell a real brass lantern from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 16, spring of year 13

Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Hamish has a suspect and is probably right. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Hamish and a neighbour outside Terrace Twelve; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about the old tunnels. Hamish read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Hamish was hired to carry a spool of wire from Terrace Twelve to the pollinators' hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded. The weather turned. Hamish moved the bolt of linen indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the price of lamp oil.

Entry 17, autumn of year 14

Someone left a iron kettle on the doorstep with no note. Hamish has a suspect and is probably right. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Hamish and a neighbour outside the Canopy Walk; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Hamish moved the coil of rope indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tax on doors. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. The weather turned. Hamish moved the sextant indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the old tunnels.

Entry 18, summer of year 14

A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Hamish and a neighbour outside the tether docks; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Hollis came by asking about who really won the regatta. Hamish said nothing useful and made tea instead. The weather turned. Hamish moved the grain scale indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the missing shipment. Hamish won 80 seed-notes on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 19, winter of year 14

The weather turned. Hamish moved the grain scale indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew. Hamish was hired to carry a signal flag from Terrace Twelve to the Canopy Walk without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Hamish spent the day counting stock at Terrace Twelve: 16 of everything, except the glass float, which is always short.

Entry 20, autumn of year 14

Hamish was hired to carry a glass float from Terrace Twelve to the tether docks without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Hamish won 20 seed-notes on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on supper. The weather turned. Hamish moved the cracked compass indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the quarantine. Hamish spent the day counting stock at Terrace Twelve: 8 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short.

Entry 21, summer of year 14

The weather turned. Hamish moved the glass float indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the comet. The weather turned. Hamish moved the spool of wire indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the comet. The weather turned. Hamish moved the spool of wire indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew. Kestrel came by asking about the quarantine. Hamish said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Hamish read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 22, winter of year 14

At the root-cellar markets, Hamish taught a newcomer how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Hamish read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the root-cellar markets, Hamish taught a newcomer how to tell a real brass lantern from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 23, winter of year 14

Hamish closed early, walked to Terrace Twelve, and watched the lights come on. Hamish repaired the wax seal at the pollinators' hall for Farida, who paid in 73 seed-notes and a long story about the right way to mend a net. The weather turned. Hamish moved the clockwork bird indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the singing at the docks. Hamish was hired to carry a bundle of letters from the pollinators' hall to Terrace Twelve without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 24, autumn of year 14

the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about the new curfew. Hamish read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. Hamish found a sack of salt

half-buried near the Canopy Walk and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Someone left a hand bell on the doorstep with no note. Hamish has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 25, summer of year 14

The weather turned. Hamish moved the sextant indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the harvest count. The weather turned. Hamish moved the cracked compass indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the harvest count. A stranger asked Hamish for the password to the workshop. Hamish laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Someone left a sextant on the doorstep with no note. Hamish has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 26, autumn of year 14

Rumours about the missing shipment reached the Canopy Walk. Hamish pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Qadira came by asking about the singing at the docks. Hamish said nothing useful and made tea instead. Hamish found a bolt of linen half-buried near the Canopy Walk and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about the harvest count. Hamish read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Hamish for the password to the workshop. Hamish laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 27, spring of year 14

At the root-cellar markets, Hamish taught a newcomer how to tell a real oilskin map from a fake one by weight alone. A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Hamish and a neighbour outside the root-cellar markets; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Hamish spent the day counting stock at the root-cellar markets: 71 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short. Hamish found a clockwork bird half-buried near the root-cellar markets and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. At the root-cellar markets, Hamish taught a newcomer how to tell a real pair of spectacles from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 28, spring of year 14

Hamish closed early, walked to the Canopy Walk, and watched the lights come on. At the tether docks, Hamish taught a newcomer how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone. At the tether docks, Hamish taught a newcomer how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone.